

APPROVED 1 JUNE 1951

AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

FROM (Agency)	REPORT NO.	PAGE	OF	PAGES
Dir/Int, Hq NSAC	IS-4-51	2	2	

1. The following described unidentified aircraft/object was sighted off the coast of Newfoundland by MATS Navy C-54 crew.

R5D

a. Originally sighted as a single, heavy, yellowish light, similar in appearance to that of a city. As object approached observing aircraft, it grew very bright and large, and appeared to be semi-circular in shape. Near aircraft, it did a 180° turn and was last seen as a small ball disappearing over the horizon. The speed was "terrific" and the size "tremendous" to quote observers. (The difference in size between the time it was first seen and last seen as a small ball going over the horizon was described as tremendous, at least 100 times larger.)

b. Sighted at 0055Z on 10 February 1951 and remained visible for approximately 7 or 8 minutes.

R5D #56501

c. Visually observed from MATS Navy C-54 #6501 of VR-1 Squadron based at Patuxent, Maryland, flying at 10,000 feet altitude, 172 knots air speed, 225° true course.

d. Observing aircraft was at 49° 50' N 50° 30' W at the time of observation. Object appeared near the water's surface at approximately a 45° downward angle from the observing aircraft and was making good a true course of approximately 125°. Upon approaching observing aircraft, it executed a sudden turn approximating 180° and disappeared very rapidly over the horizon.

e. Object sighted by 5 crew members, listed below, of the above aircraft, who are all experienced North Atlantic fliers. Gander Traffic Control reports no other aircraft known to be in the vicinity at time of sighting. All 5 observers agree on facts as stated, but there has been no confirmation from other sources. Believe C-3 appropriate.

Lt Fred W. Kingdom - 173390 (first to see object)
Lt A. L. Jonas - 391096
Lt G. E. Bethune - 299055
Lt N. G. P. Koger - 306873
Lt J. M. Meyer - 263836

f. Weather clear, visibility from 15 miles to unlimited, no other weather information available.

g. No unusual meteorological activity known to exist and having any influence on the sighting. This object could not have been a comet as the object was below and between the aircraft and ocean.

h. No physical evidence available.

i. No interception action taken.

2. The above information was forwarded from this Headquarters to Headquarters, ESAP by 10 February 1951 by TAC 101, NEAC EN 0212, and EN 0215.



DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
HEADQUARTERS UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
WASHINGTON 25, D.C.

UNCLASSIFIED

AFOIU-7/TC

FEB 28 1951

SUBJECT: (Unclassified) Sighting of Unidentified Flying Object

TO: Commanding General
Air Materiel Command
Wright-Patterson Air Force Base
Dayton, Ohio
ATTN: Chief, Intelligence Department

AXA 1a

1. Reference is made to radnote, this headquarters, date time group 132056, concerning unidentified flying object sighting on 10 February 1951. The inclosed statements were obtained upon interrogation of the Naval personnel making this sighting.

2. Forwarded for your information.

BY COMMAND OF THE CHIEF OF STAFF:

LESTER S. HARRIS
Colonel, USAF
Chief, Technical Capabilities Branch
Evaluation Division
Directorate of Intelligence

7 Incls

1. Statement fr LT Kingdon
2. Statement fr LTJG Jones
3. Statement fr LT Koger
4. Statement fr LT Bethune
5. Statement fr LT Meyer
6. Statement fr ALC Shiever
7. Statement fr AB3 Daniels

File Bridge

512.7

UNCLASSIFIED

DOWNGRADED AT 5 YEAR INTERVALS;
DECLASSIFIED AFTER 12 YEARS.
DOD DIR 5200.10

ITEM 4 AMC /CONFIDENTIAL/
FROM JJ RODGERS MCIAXA-1A UNCLASSIFIED
TO COL HARRIS AFOIN-V/TC

REFERENCE RECENT RADNOTE MESSAGES FROM YOUR HEADQUARTERS CONCERNING SIGHTING OF UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECT IN THE VICINITY OF NEWFOUNDLAND BY NAVY AIRCREW. BASED UPON THE INFORMATION PRESENTED, IT IS IMPOSSIBLE TO COME TO DEFINITE CONCLUSIONS REGARDING THE SIGHTING. HOWEVER, THE MATTER WAS DISCUSSED IN SOME DETAIL WITH AN ASTRONOMER ATTACHED TO THE AMC GRADUATE CENTER AS A RESULT OF THIS DISCUSSION IT WAS CONCLUDED THAT WHILE THERE IS A POSSIBILITY OF THE OBJECT SIGHTED BEING A METEOR OR FIREBALL, THE DESCRIPTION FURNISHED GIVES REASON TO BELIEVE THAT THE AIRCREW SAW AN UNUSUAL "NORTHERN LIGHTS" DISPLAY. NO FURTHER ACTION IS CONTEMPLATED ON THIS INCIDENT UNLESS ADDITIONAL INFORMATION IS RECEIVED WHICH WOULD TEND TO CHANGE OUR ESTIMATE OF THE SITUATION.

END ITEM 4 AMC /CONFIDENTIAL/
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TO CGAMC WP AFB OHIO

AF GRNC

UNCLASSIFIED

1/4 E S ~~SECRET~~ D/ RADNOTE FOR MCISXD FROM AFOIN-C/DD-13/CAPT OSTREM

THE FOLLOWING CABLE IS QUOTED FOR YOUR INFORMATION: "VR-1 PILOTS OFF

LIGHT N-125 ENROUTE KEFLAVIK TO ARGENTIA ON COURSE 225 TRUE
AT 10,000 FEET REPORTED AN UNIDENTIFIED RED AND YELLOW OBJECT AT
100055Z INITIALLY BEARING 200 RELATIVE. OBJECT APPEARED TO BE CLOSE
TO SURFACE. SHAPE INDEFINITE WHEN FIRST SIGHTED LATER APPEARING
CIRCULAR. DIAMETER ESTIMATE EXCESS 400 FEET. OBJECT APPROACHED
PLANE TURNED AND DISAPPEARED OVER HORIZON ON COURSE 290 TRUE AT
TREMENDOUS SPEED. 100055Z POSITION LATITUDE 49-52 NORTH LONG 50-03
WEST. SIGHTING REPORTED TO GANGER ATC PLAIN LANGUAGE."

TT-071-PH
20 February 51
MCIAXA/Rodgers

STUDENT
INFORMATION

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675-25303

12/2150Z

COPY

10 FEB 51 UNCLASSIFIED

FROM: NEAC PEPPERELL AFB NELD

TO : CSAF WASH D C

NR : EN 0212

Unidentified object seen at 0055Z 10 Feb/degrees 50 min north, 50 degrees 03 min west by crew of Navy 6501, VRI, Petuxent River, MD. Originally seen as heavy light in distance on the surface as lights of city. The yellowish light, like a fire in color, approached rapidly and grew very bright and very large with a semi-circular shape. It was on a true course of about 125 degrees, plane on a true course of 225 degrees, as it approached the plane it suddenly turned about almost 180 degrees and disappeared rapidly over the horizon as a small ball. Speed "was terrific". Seen fr an angle of about 45 degrees looking down fr the plane. Crew all experienced North-Atlantic fliers Lt F.W. Kingdon, Lt. A. L. Jones, Lt. G.E. Bethune, Lt. N.G.P. Koger, Lt. J.M. Meyer, all saw object over a period of fr seven to eight min. Plane flying at 10,000 altitude.

ACTION: OIN

CAF IN: 97532

(10 Feb 51)

MEL/rof

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SAN PLAIN

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FLEET LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

10 February 1951

UNCLASSIFIED

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

I, Graham E. BETHUNE, was Co-Pilot on Flight 125 from Keflavik, Iceland to Naval Air Station, Argentia on the 10th of February 1951. At 0055Z I gained and observed the following object:

SIGHTED While flying in the left seat at 10,000 feet on a true course of 230 degrees at a position of 49-50 North 50-03 West, I observed a glow of light below the horizon about 1,000 to 1,500 feet above the water. Its bearing was about 2:00 Clock. There was no overcast, there was a thin transparent group of scuds at about 2,000 feet altitude. After examining the object for 40 to 50 seconds I called it to the attention of Lieutenant KINGDON in the right hand seat. It was under the thin scuds at roughly 30 to 40 miles away. I asked "What is it, a ship lighted up or a city, I know it can't be a city because we are over 250 miles out". We both observed its course and motion for about 4 or 5 minutes before calling it to the attention of the other crew members. Its first glow was a dull yellow. We were on an intercepting course. Suddenly its angle of attack changed, its altitude and size increased as though its speed was in excess of 1,000 miles per hour. It closed in so fast that the first feeling was we would collide in mid air. At this time its angle changed and the color changed. It then was definitely circular and redish orange on its perimeter. It reversed its course and tripled its speed until it was last seen disappearing over the horizon. Because of our altitude and misleading distance over water it is almost impossible to estimate its size, distance and speed. A rough estimate would be at least 300 feet in diameter, over 1,000 miles per hour in speed and approached within 5 miles of the aircraft.

(500 FEET)

/s/ Graham E. BETHUNE
LT, U. S. Naval Reserve.

ENCLOSURE (4)

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DOD DIR 5200.10

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FLEET LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

UNCLASSIFIED

10 February 1951

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

At 0055Z on 10 February 1951, while serving as second Plane Commander on above flight, I was an eye witness to an unusual sighting of an unidentified object. This occurrence took place at approximately 49-50 N and 50-03 W, which is approximately 200 miles north east of Argentina, Newfoundland. We were at 10,000 feet altitude cruising on a true course of about 230° at time of incident.

At time of sighting I was occupying the right hand (CoPilots) seat and the left hand (Pilots) seat was occupied by Lieutenant G. E. BETHUNE.

My attention was first called to the occurrence by Mr. BETHUNE, who asked me to look at an unusual light which was to my right. I then saw that there was a glowing light beneath a thin layer of strato-form clouds beneath us. This light was to my right and down at an angle of about 45°. This object appeared to lie on the surface and was throwing a yellowish-orange glare through the cloud deck. It appeared to be very large and I at first thought that it could be a large ship completely illuminated.

Mr. BETHUNE and I watched the object for several minutes in trying to determine its nature. We then called out Navigator, Lieutenant N. J. P. KOGER to the cockpit to scrutinize the object and render his opinion as to its nature.

While further observing the object I saw that it suddenly started ascending through the cloud layer and it then became quite bright. The object was very large and was circular with a glowing yellow-orange ring around its outer edge. This object appeared to be climbing and moving at a tremendous speed, and it appeared to be on a more or less collision course with our aircraft. When it appeared that there was a possibility of collision the object appeared to make a 180° turn and disappeared over the horizon at a terrific speed. During the course of events LTJG A. L. JONES had come to the cockpit and he made a turn in the direction of the object but it went out of sight in a short period of time.

Due to the fact that this object was seen over water at night it would be most difficult for me to estimate speed, size or distance we were from it during the course of events. However, the speed was tremendous and the size was at least 200 to 300 feet in diameter. The object was close enough to me to see and observe it clearly.

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Upon request, I will attempt to submit a more detailed and complete report of my observations.

Upon arrival at HAS, Argentina, I was contacted by Capt. D. H. PAULSEN, USAF, who interrogated me relative to the subject.

/s/ Fred W. KINGDON, Jr.
LT, U. S. Navy

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DECLASSIFIED AFTER 12 YEARS
DOD DIR 5200.10

UNCLASSIFIED

FIRST LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

UNCLASSIFIED

10 February 1951

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/B, February 1951

1. At 0055Z, 10 February 1951, I was the Plane Commander of Flight 125/09, RAB Bureau Number 56501, enroute from Keflavik, Iceland to Argentina, Newfoundland at 10,000 feet on an instrument flight plan. Our position at 10/0055Z was 49-50 North, 50-03 West, on a true heading of 230°, ground speed 118 knots. The weather was clear with about 60 miles visibility and thin stratus clouds at about 4,000.

2. I was in the cabin of the plane checking the passengers when one of the navigators, Lieutenant W. J. P. KOGER, came aft and pointed to this phenomena. I watched it for a minute and went forward to the cockpit to get a better view. Upon reaching the cockpit, I took the plane off of the autopilot and turned to a true heading of 290° in pursuit of the object. The object left on a heading of about 290° true and went over the horizon in a very short time.

3. I would guess the speed to be well over 1500 miles per hour, and the diameter to be at least 300 feet.

4. My first view of it resembled a huge fiery orange disc on its edge. As it went further away, the center became darker, but the edge still threw off a fiery hue. When it went over the horizon, it seemed to go from a vertical position to a horizontal position, with only the trailing edge showing in a half-moon effect. Since I was not the first to see it, it was going away from the plane when I was notified. Copilot Lieutenant G. E. BETHUNE was flying the plane and Second Plane Commander Lieutenant Fred KINGDON was flying on the right side at the time of the incident.

5. At 10/0104Z, I called Gander Tower on VHF and asked them if Gander A. T. C. had any information of an aircraft at that position and time. They had no such information and notified the military of our sighting. When we landed at Argentina at 10/0240Z, we were interrogated by Capt. D. H. PAULSEN, USAF, Pepperell AFB, and CDR WEHMEYER, C.O., VP-8, Argentina. The extreme speed, maneuverability, and brilliance of the object made our estimates as to the distance and size very difficult.

/s/A. L. JONES
LTJG, US. S. NAVY

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DOD DIR 5200.10